

D770

Secondary Literacy Methods and Interventions

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

After reading a one-page article on water pollution, a ninth grader in Tier 2 writes a “summary” that copies six sentences from the text. The article has a bright chart and was published by a science magazine. What should the teacher teach?

- A. A GIST routine: identify who or what, the most important point, and why, in about 20 words.
- B. Retell every detail in order.
- C. Copy more sentences so the summary is complete.
- D. Describe the chart in detail.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Tenth graders in a biology class keep meeting words like “hydrology,” “hydrate,” and “dehydration.” The teacher has a word wall and 32 students. Which instruction gives students the most power with these words?

- A. Skip the words since they are too hard.
- B. Teach the root hydr- (water) and common affixes like de- and -ology, then have students work out related words.
- C. Post each word and definition on the word wall to memorize.
- D. Have students look up each word in the dictionary.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student knows that “micro” means small, “bio” means life, and “-logy” means study of. Which unfamiliar word can she most fully figure out from its parts?

- A. Logistics
- B. Bicycle
- C. Microphone
- D. Microbiology

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

An eighth-grade social studies passage says, “Because the river flooded, farmers lost their crops. As a result, food prices rose.” The passage is two pages long and includes a map. Which text structure should students use to organize notes?

- A. Compare and contrast
- B. Cause and effect
- C. Description, because of the map
- D. Sequence

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants students to practice problem-solution structure. Which sentence contains its signal?

- A. “First, the city studied traffic. Next, it held meetings.”
- B. “Because traffic grew, travel times increased.”
- C. “One way the city solved the traffic problem was to add bus lanes.”
- D. “Unlike cars, buses carry many riders.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A ninth grader reads fluently but is lost in a chapter about the Silk Road, a topic he has never studied. He enjoys video games and sits in the back row. What should the teacher do before and during reading?

- A. Move him to the front row.
- B. Teach a general strategy and have him reread the chapter.
- C. Give him a phonics intervention.
- D. Build background with a short video, map, and key terms, and connect ideas during reading.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A tenth grader reading two years below grade level avoids reading, saying books are “for little kids.” The intervention room has bright posters and the school just started later in the morning. Which change is most likely to increase engagement?

- A. Assign the same early-grade books with larger print.
- B. Add more bright posters to the room.
- C. Offer a choice of high-interest, age-appropriate texts at an accessible level and chances to discuss them with peers.
- D. Offer candy for every page read.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A ninth grader in Tier 2 has scored at or above benchmark on the last four progress-monitoring probes. She has a part-time job and her group meets in the library. What is the best decision?

- A. Move her to Tier 3.
- B. Move her to Tier 1 with continued monitoring for a period to confirm she stays on track.
- C. Exit her because of her job schedule.
- D. Keep her in Tier 2 all year to be safe.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which student’s data most clearly support moving to a more intensive tier?

- A. A student whose last four scores are above benchmark.
- B. A student who has been in Tier 2 for only one week.
- C. A student with one low score after a sick day.
- D. A student with 10 weeks of well-delivered Tier 2 whose scores are flat and below the goal line.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

Students read a short story and are asked, “Why do you think the character hid the letter?” A student with a learning disability keeps searching for a sentence with the answer. The story is set in a lighthouse and is 12 pages long. What should the teacher teach?

- A. This is an Author and You question: combine clues from the story with what you know.
- B. This is an On My Own question; the story is not needed.
- C. This is a Right There question; keep searching.
- D. Read the lighthouse section again for the exact answer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A question asks, “List three reasons the author gives for building the dam.” The reasons appear in different paragraphs. Which QAR type is this?

- A. Right There
- B. Author and You
- C. Think and Search
- D. On My Own

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A seventh grader finishes a page of a science text and cannot say what it was about. She did not stop at any point while reading. Her class uses tablets and meets third period. What should the teacher teach?

- A. Teach her to stop after each paragraph, check whether it made sense, and use fix-ups like rereading when it did not.
- B. Switch the text to a tablet version.
- C. Have her read faster to keep her attention.
- D. Tell her to keep reading to the end no matter what.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer A Concept 1

After reading a one-page article on water pollution, a ninth grader in Tier 2 writes a “summary” that copies six sentences from the text. ~~The article has a bright chart and was published by a science magazine.~~ What should the teacher teach?

Target word: summarizing method **Decides:** He copies details instead of condensing the main idea.

A	Correct	GIST forces selecting and condensing key ideas.
B	Adjacent category	Retelling is not summarizing.
C	Inverted operation	More copying moves farther from summarizing.
D	Camouflage	The chart is not the main idea.

2. Answer B Concept 2

Tenth graders in a biology class keep meeting words like “hydrology,” “hydrate,” and “dehydration.” ~~The teacher has a word wall and 32 students.~~ Which instruction gives students the most power with these words?

Target word: morphology instruction **Decides:** The words share the root hydr- (water).

A	Absolute language	Content words are essential to learning.
B	Correct	Word parts unlock whole families of words.
C	Camouflage	Uses the word wall but teaches words one at a time.
D	Dropped element	Drops the shared-part insight that generalizes.

3. Answer D Concept 2 · transfer

A student knows that “micro” means small, “bio” means life, and “-logy” means study of. Which unfamiliar word can she most fully figure out from its parts?

Target word: apply morphology **Decides:** A word built entirely from parts she knows.

A	Confusion set	Starts with “log” but is not the suffix -logy.
B	Confusion set	Bi- means two, not life; a look-alike prefix.
C	Dropped element	She knows micro, but “phone” (sound) is not one of her known parts.
D	Correct	Micro (small) + bio (life) + -logy (study of): the study of tiny living things.

4. Answer B Concept 3

An eighth-grade social studies passage says, “Because the river flooded, farmers lost their crops. As a result, food prices rose.” ~~The passage is two pages long and includes a map.~~ Which text structure should students use to organize notes?

Target word: identify structure **Decides:** Signal words “because” and “as a result.”

A	Confusion set	No similarities or differences are signaled.
B	Correct	“Because” and “as a result” signal causes and their effects.
C	Camouflage	The map does not decide the text structure.
D	Adjacent category	Events are ordered, but the links are causes.

5. Answer C Concept 3 · transfer

A teacher wants students to practice problem-solution structure. Which sentence contains its signal?

Target word: find the signal **Decides:** Problem-solution signals: problem, solution, solve.

A	Confusion set	“First” and “next” signal sequence.
B	Adjacent category	Cause-effect, not problem-solution.
C	Correct	Names a problem and a solution.
D	Confusion set	“Unlike” signals compare-contrast.

6. Answer D Concept 4

A ninth grader reads fluently but is lost in a chapter about the Silk Road, a topic he has never studied. ~~He enjoys video games and sits in the back row.~~ What should the teacher do before and during reading?

Target word: support when topic is unfamiliar **Decides:** Low background knowledge limits comprehension.

A	Camouflage	Seating does not build knowledge.
B	Dropped element	Strategies help, but they cannot supply missing knowledge.
C	Adjacent category	He reads fluently; decoding is not the gap.
D	Correct	Topic knowledge is a major driver of comprehension.

7. Answer C Concept 5

A tenth grader reading two years below grade level avoids reading, saying books are “for little kids.” ~~The intervention room has bright posters and the school just started later in the morning.~~ Which change is most likely to increase engagement?

Target word: engagement for older struggling readers **Decides:** Choice and age-respectful, relevant text at a readable level.

A	Inverted operation	Reinforces the “little kids” complaint.
B	Camouflage	Decor does not change the reading experience.
C	Correct	Choice, relevance, and collaboration raise engagement.
D	Adjacent category	Rewards alone do not build lasting engagement.

8. Answer B Concept 6

A ninth grader in Tier 2 has scored at or above benchmark on the last four progress-monitoring probes. ~~She has a part-time job and her group meets in the library.~~ What is the best decision?

Target word: tier movement **Decides:** Consistently at or above benchmark.

A	Inverted operation	Tier 3 is for poor response, not success.
B	Correct	Consistent success supports exit, with monitoring after.
C	Camouflage	The job does not decide tier placement.
D	Absolute language	Unneeded intervention takes time from other learning.

9. Answer D Concept 6 • transfer

Which student's data most clearly support moving to a more intensive tier?

Target word: reverse: when to intensify **Decides:** Flat or declining data below goal after adequate Tier 2.

A	Inverted operation	That supports exit, not intensifying.
B	Wrong stem number	Too little time to judge response.
C	Dropped element	One point is not a trend.
D	Correct	Inadequate response to good intervention calls for intensifying.

10. Answer A Concept 7

Students read a short story and are asked, "Why do you think the character hid the letter?" A student with a learning disability keeps searching for a sentence with the answer. ~~The story is set in a lighthouse and is 12 pages long.~~ What should the teacher teach?

Target word: QAR type **Decides:** The answer needs text clues plus the reader's thinking.

A	Correct	Inference questions require text plus reader knowledge.
B	Adjacent category	The answer depends on story clues.
C	Confusion set	The answer is not stated in one place.
D	Camouflage	The setting is irrelevant; no exact sentence exists.

11. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A question asks, "List three reasons the author gives for building the dam." The reasons appear in different paragraphs. Which QAR type is this?

Target word: classify QAR **Decides:** Answer is in the text but spread across places.

A	Confusion set	Right There answers are in one place.
B	Adjacent category	No inference beyond the text is needed.
C	Correct	The answer is in the text but must be pulled from several places.
D	Inverted operation	The answer comes from the text, not only the reader.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A seventh grader finishes a page of a science text and cannot say what it was about. She did not stop at any point while reading. ~~Her class uses tablets and meets third period.~~ What should the teacher teach?

Target word: comprehension monitoring **Decides:** She does not notice when meaning breaks down.

A	Correct	Monitoring plus fix-up strategies repairs breakdowns.
B	Camouflage	The device does not teach monitoring.
C	Inverted operation	Speeding up worsens missed meaning.
D	Absolute language	Pushing on without repair builds the problem.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	4	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	7	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Summarizing with GIST	Students condense a section into a short statement of the most important who/what/why, dropping minor details, which strengthens comprehension.	Letting students copy sentences or retell every detail and calling it a summary.	Students' summaries are as long as the text or list details.
2	Morphology for adolescent vocabulary	Teaching common prefixes, roots, and suffixes lets students work out many related academic words.	Teaching word lists by memorizing definitions only.	Many unfamiliar content words share Latin or Greek parts.
3	Text structure	Recognizing an informational text's structure (cause-effect, compare-contrast, problem-solution, sequence, description) and its signal words helps students organize and recall ideas.	Treating all informational text as a list of facts.	Signal words such as "as a result," "however," or "one solution."
4	Building background knowledge	Comprehension depends heavily on what readers already know; building topic knowledge before and during reading helps struggling readers understand.	Assuming a general strategy alone will make any unfamiliar text understandable.	A student decodes well but is lost in a text on an unfamiliar topic.
5	Adolescent motivation and engagement	Choice, relevance, collaboration, and texts students can succeed with increase engagement for older struggling readers.	Using only rewards or babyish materials to motivate teens.	An older struggling reader avoids reading tasks.
6	Data rules for moving between tiers	Students move to more intensive tiers when data show inadequate response and move to less intensive tiers when they meet benchmark or goal consistently, with continued monitoring after exit.	Keeping students in intervention indefinitely or exiting after one good score.	Several progress-monitoring points relative to a goal or benchmark.
7	Question-Answer Relationships (QAR)	QAR teaches students where answers come from: Right There, Think and Search (in the text), Author and You, On My Own (in your head).	Believing every answer must be found word-for-word in one sentence.	Students search the text for an answer that requires inference.
8	Comprehension monitoring and fix-up strategies	Skilled readers notice when understanding breaks down and use fix-up strategies such as rereading, reading ahead, or using word parts and context.	Reading to the end of the page even when meaning is lost.	A student finishes reading but cannot say what it was about and never noticed.

Course scope (public description): Secondary Literacy Methods & Interventions utilizes MTSS to equip educators with evidence-based strategies to address adolescents' reading challenges through the Multi-Tiered System of Supports Model. Candidates learn to identify, monitor, and provide differentiated instruction, integrating screening tools and progress monitoring to enhance comprehension. The course emphasizes the development of personalized intervention plans while utilizing reading assessments for informed instructional decisions. By

completion, candidates compile intervention strategies supporting learners across MTSS tiers, fostering inclusive environments for academic success.